

Fluidstack

AI Infrastructure · GPU Cloud / Data-Centre Builder · New York (founded in Oxford, 2017) · Private (~\$18B reported; \$1.5B round, Sep 2026)

Fluidstack, the Oxford-born AI-infrastructure builder now constructing Anthropic's \$50B US data-centre programme, has reportedly closed a \$1.5B round led by Jane Street at an \$18B valuation (Forbes, 3 Sep 2026), more than doubling the \$7.5B mark it set only in July.

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OPPORTUNITY / 100

TIMING WINDOW

HOT

SERIES

F1

RECOMMENDED TEAM

Atlassian
Williams Racing

ACTION HORIZON

6-10 WKS

THE CASE

Forbes reported on 3 September that Fluidstack raised \$1.5B led by Jane Street at an \$18B valuation; Crunchbase News puts total funding just over \$2.6B. The company has not announced the round. It closed a ~\$750M round at ~\$7.5B in July after Bloomberg-sourced talks in April, so the price has more than doubled in two months. The business behind it is real: Anthropic's \$50B US infrastructure programme, announced 12 Nov 2025, starts with Fluidstack-built data centres in Texas and New York, with sites coming online through 2026.

The grid has already priced this archetype: CoreWeave became Aston Martin Aramco's Official AI Cloud Computing Partner in May 2025, and Core Scientific sits on Cadillac's first roster. Jane Street is the common thread, having committed billions of compute spend to CoreWeave and Crusoe before backing Fluidstack outright. Fluidstack is the one of the three with no seat, and its anchor customer's brand, Claude, already races on a Williams.

WHY NOW

The round was reported on 3 September; brand budgets reset in the quarter after a raise. Austin (late October) and Las Vegas (November) are the US stages left in 2026, and teams close 2027 partner rosters in the fourth quarter.

PROOF POINTS — EVERY FIGURE VERIFIED TO A PRIMARY SOURCE (SEE P.2)

\$1.5B

\$1.5B round led by Jane Street at an \$18B valuation, reported by Forbes (3 Sep 2026) and Crunchbase News; n...

\$2.6B

Jane Street (lead); total funding just over \$2.6B (Crunchbase News)

\$50B

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\$750M

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GRID FIT — CATEGORY-WHITESPACE CHECK ACROSS THE F1 GRID (SPONSOR TABLE; 49 OF 346 PARTNER ROWS CATEGORISED)

Atlassian Williams Racing	OPEN	no rival in this category lane
McLaren Mastercard F1 Team	TAKEN	Dell Technologies, Google Cloud
Aston Martin Aramco F1 Team	TAKEN	CoreWeave, NetApp
Mercedes-AMG Petronas F1 Team	TAKEN	Microsoft

BOTTOM LINE

A reported \$1.5B round at \$18B, a \$50B Anthropic build-out on Fluidstack sites, and Claude already on the Williams put Fluidstack at peak brand-investment authority with a warm path in. The compute lane at Williams is open and two US races remain inside the window.

WHY ATLASSIAN WILLIAMS RACING

Williams has the most data-native roster on the grid: Atlassian as title partner, VAST Data for the data platform, Keeper for identity, and since this season Claude as Official Thinking Partner inside race strategy and car development. There is no cloud or GPU-compute partner. Fluidstack builds Anthropic's compute, so the introduction runs through a partner Williams already trusts. Oxford roots give a British team a home story; New York gives the US rounds one too.

VALUE TO ATLASSIAN WILLIAMS RACING — MODE A (TECH IN THE CAR / CHAMPIONSHIP)

MODE A - operational. The work outside the FIA aero-testing limits is compute-hungry: machine-learning surrogates, driver-in-loop and strategy simulation, telemetry and video analytics between sessions. Claude already sits in that workflow at Williams; Fluidstack supplies the elastic GPU capacity beneath it, on demand, without cost-cap capital. In return: a named compute partnership, livery presence and Austin and Las Vegas hospitality for Fluidstack's enterprise and capital-markets audience.

DEAL ARCHITECTURE

Entry as Official AI Compute Partner. **THREE YEARS**, 2027-2029, spanning the Anthropic build-out and a probable listing window. Estimated \$4-7M a year, part-payable in compute credits. Scope: engine-cover or sidepod placement, naming of the team's compute environment, US-race hospitality, engineering content with the Claude programme.

PRIMARY DECISION-MAKER

Gary Wu

CO-FOUNDER & CEO, FLUIDSTACK · VERIFIED

Wu co-founded Fluidstack in Oxford in 2017 and fronts every raise; a first sports partnership is his call. Path: César Maklary, Co-Founder and President (commercial), and Rob Perdue, COO since February 2025. No chief marketing officer is listed.

OPENING ANGLE

Lead with the Claude connection.

“Gary, Claude already races on the Williams; you build Anthropic's compute. CoreWeave took its seat at Aston Martin in the year of its listing, and the compute lane at Williams is open. 25 minutes before Austin to see the numbers?”

SCORE COMPOSITION

TIMING 17 / 20 Round reported 3 Sep; Austin and Las Vegas inside the window.	CAPACITY 18 / 20 \$1.5B raise at \$18B (reported); ~\$2.6B raised in total.	BRAND FIT 14 / 20 B2B infrastructure brand; strong Anthropic-Williams tie.	URGENCY 12 / 20 Listing talk only; no hard deadline beyond Q4 rosters.	OPS FIT 15 / 20 MODE A: elastic GPU capacity outside the aero cap.
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RISKS & COUNTERS

REPORTED, NOT CONFIRMED The \$1.5B round and the \$18B valuation come from Forbes and Crunchbase News; there is no company release. **Counter:** Anchor the pitch on the confirmed Anthropic programme; ask Fluidstack to confirm the round on the first call.

CROWDED ARCHETYPE CoreWeave, Core Scientific and Crusoe are all courting or holding grid positions; a fourth neocloud can look like a follower. **Counter:** Position Williams as the only team where the compute partner meets its own anchor customer's brand on the car.

SOURCES — 15 OF 15 LOAD-BEARING CLAIMS VERIFIED

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